

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Pronunciation Spot: Every little bit helps to stay healthy, even laughter!



Learning Outcome

Exchange advice and suggestions in communicative situations.

Ask your partner:

- What do you think the expression "laughter therapy" means?
- Do you take vitamins like Vitamin C? Why or why not?
- What are some ways to stay healthy?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about staying healthy.
- I can say and use the sound tw.
- I can use proper intonation in long statements.





Let's Explore!

Sally writes about a new medical treatment ... laughter **therapy***!

* A "therapy" is a procedure designed to cure an illness or fix another type of health problem.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Here's a story for your Twitter feed. In 1964, Norman Cousins, the editor of one of the most popular magazines in America, the *Saturday Review*, was told by his doctor that he only had a short time left to live. He was diagnosed with a severe form of arthritis that causes people great pain as their joints become increasingly stiff.

To fight the disease, Cousins decided to add a twist to traditional medical treatment. He took a lot of Vitamin C and exposed himself to a steady diet of humor. He soon found that ten minutes of energetic laughter and a dose of Vitamin C allowed him two hours of painless sleep, and the inflammation in his joints had decreased. Cousins was convinced that "laughter therapy" was the key to his recovery.

Norman Cousins lived until the year 1990. By that time, he had become famous not only as a magazine editor but also as the discoverer of a new form of medical treatment. His book *Anatomy of an Illness* persuaded many physicians to begin taking humor seriously as one means of improving their patients' health. Now that's something to tweet about!





Let's Practice!

Can you say the /tw/ consonant combination?

Instructions: Organize the mystery words. Write a sentence for each word. Read the words and sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor. Compare your pronunciation with a partner.

1. winTa _____.

2. tneywT _____.

3. gtilhwTi _____.

4. iwTtsre _____.

5. stiwT _____.



Let's Practice!

Do you get enough Vitamin C?

Instructions: Read the paragraph. Write the missing words correctly. Use words from the box below. Read the text aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

laughter

recovery

humor

Vitamin C

diet

dose

therapy

treatment

Cousins added a twist to traditional medical _____. He exposed himself to a steady _____ of _____ and a good _____ of _____. Cousins was convinced that " _____ " was the key to his _____.



Extension Activity

Learn a few jokes in English and tell them to your partner.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go online to find 3 - 5 jokes in English. Make sure you understand the jokes and you think they are funny.
- Practice saying the important words in each joke.
- Practice the jokes without reading them.
- Tell the jokes to a partner.
- With your partner, decide which joke is the funniest.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I practice
saying 3 - 5
jokes in
English.

☐ ☐

I tell the jokes.

☐ ☐

I decide which
joke is the
funniest.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **joint** (noun): part of the body that bends, like at the finger, elbow or knee
e.g. Arthritis causes people great pain as their joints become stiff.
- **arthritis** (noun): a disease affecting the movement of joints in the body
e.g. Arthritis is a disease that affects the joints of the body.
- **to be diagnosed** (expression): to have a health problem proven by medical tests
e.g. Norman Cousins was diagnosed with a severe form of arthritis.
- **add a twist** (expression): change; alter in some way
e.g. Cousins decided to add a twist to traditional medical treatment.
- **recovery** (noun): improved health condition
e.g. Cousins was convinced that "laughter therapy" was the key to his recovery.
- **dose** (noun): amount taken, usually of a medication
e.g. A dose of Vitamin C allowed him two hours of painless sleep.
- **humor** (noun): the ability to find things comical funny
e.g. Cousins exposed himself to a steady diet of humor.





Learning Points

Consonant Blends - The /tw/ Sound

Consonant clusters like /tw/ can occur at the beginning of a word in English.

Practice blending the sound from one consonant sound into the next without adding a vowel sound in between.

Read the following words aloud.

twitter	tweet	twice	twist
twin	twig	tweak	twenty

Examples:

- *Here's a story for your Twitter feed.*
- *Now that's something to tweet about!*

Breaking Sentences into Parts

When you read or speak in English, you often "chunk" or break the sentence into parts based on the meaning contained in each part.

For example, look at the sentence:

To fight the disease, Cousins decided to add a twist to traditional medical treatment.

This sentence could be chunked or broken into the following parts:

To fight the disease,
Cousins decided
to add a twist
to traditional medical treatment.

Examples:

- *To fight the disease, * Cousins decided * to add a twist * to traditional medical treatment.*

